

Alimatou Diagne

Senior UX Designer | African and Emerging Markets

Dakar, Senegal - Remote, full-time or part-time - GMT / West Africa time zones

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PROFILE

Senior UX researcher with 10+ years combining qualitative field research and quantitative analytics across 10+ African countries. I led research and program management for the Mastercard Foundation and turned the findings into redesigned digital learning products, KPI systems and funding decisions.

I help product and program teams build for users in low-resource, multilingual markets. Trained statistician (M.Sc., ENSAE), founder who raised \$150,000+, and comfortable owning a research workstream end to end for distributed, remote teams.

SELECTED UX CASE STUDIES

- **[Women Creating Wealth — Graça Machel Trust](#)**: field research mapping the coaching journey of a pan-African cohort; friction points turned into service and data-system redesign.
- **[Funding Gap](#)**: funding-readiness platform concept for entrepreneurs stuck in the "prove it again" loop: transparent readiness score, lender matching, optional learning. Personas and coded prototype.
- **[Justice Delayed](#)**: court-appointment service for citizens who queue from 4am for a 5-minute hearing, built on courthouse testimonies: booking, SMS reminders, live queue position and USSD access for basic phones.
- **[Clinic Booking App](#)**: end-to-end product design, from user research and wireframes to a tested prototype.

Full portfolio of 17 case studies: zadya22.github.io/portofolio

CORE SKILLS

- **UX research**: user interviews, field observation, focus groups, large-scale surveys, usability testing, journey mapping, service blueprints, personas
- **Design and prototyping**: wireframing, prototyping, Figma, Adobe XD, HTML/CSS/JavaScript prototypes
- **Quantitative and product analytics**: KPI systems, dashboard design, survey design, SQL, Python, R, Power BI, SPSS, STATA
- **Data systems**: ETL pipelines, database design, M&E / MEAL frameworks, impact and donor reporting
- **Ways of working**: workshop facilitation, stakeholder alignment, remote collaboration with distributed teams

EXPERIENCE

Program Manager

Oct 2025 – Present

Mastercard Foundation × Concree, Alumni Start-ups in Transition

- Own the centralized KPI database for a full cohort of alumni startups, turning performance data into the M&E reporting used by institutional funders.
- Designed growth-metrics frameworks (revenue, jobs created, capital raised) and deliver recurring impact reports to the Mastercard Foundation.
- Coach founders 1:1 on positioning, business model and operations; design workshops on strategy, financing and growth.

Expert Consultant & Technical Coach (UX Research, Data)

Sep 2024 – Sep 2026

Graça Machel Trust, Women Creating Wealth

- Led field research (interviews, observation, focus groups) mapping the coaching experience of a pan-African cohort of women entrepreneurs; turned friction points into concrete service recommendations.
- Designed the program data system (collection, processing, visualization of impact indicators), enabling real-time adaptive learning across the cohort.
- Built KPI dashboards and donor reporting frameworks; evaluated business plans on viability, job creation and impact, with recommendations that directly informed funding decisions.
- Delivered masterclasses on entrepreneurship, growth and user-centered design.

Expert Consultant (UX Research)

Oct 2023 – Jan 2026

Mastercard Foundation × Université Cheikh Hamidou Kane, Force N

- Designed and ran large-scale user research with 14,000+ entrepreneurs across West Africa to map learning behaviors and engagement barriers.
- Translated findings into digital training modules designed around the real constraints of African learners.
- Facilitated webinars and workshops on ideation, business modeling and growth for large digital audiences.

Senior Data Analyst

Apr 2024 – Nov 2024

Compagnie Prestige Immobilier

- Deployed a statistical system centralizing company data for executive-committee decisions, automating recurring data flows.
- Cleaned, segmented and governed the client database; built forecasting models on price and demand trends that shaped investment decisions.

Co-founder

Apr 2017 – Sep 2026

Carvi Food (AgriTech)

- Took a food-processing company (dried fruit, dried meat) from concept to market, owning product, production and commercial strategy.
- Raised \$150,000+ in innovation funding through competitions and private investors.
- Built cross-functional teams (R&D, production, marketing, finance) and a local-sourcing model that expanded women's participation in the agricultural value chain.

Earlier experience

- **Data Designer / M&E Assistant — Young African Leaders Initiative (YALI), Dakar** (2018–2019): designed decision dashboards for non-technical program teams and alumni impact tracking.
- **Data Analyst Consultant — Performance Group, Big Data** (2016): led field data collection and analysis for large-scale quantitative surveys (SQL, SPSS, R, STATA).
- **Statistical and Marketing Analyst — La Voix du Client** (2014–2016): ran client-satisfaction analytics and survey quality audits.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

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|---|-------------|
| • IBM Data Engineering — IBM | In progress |
| • Google UX Design Certificate — Google | 2026 |
| • Web Applications for Everybody — University of Michigan | 2026 |
| • Project Management Foundations — University of California, Irvine | 2026 |
| • Entrepreneurship & Business Leadership — Drake University, Iowa, USA | 2019 |
| • Results-Based Project Management — Université Atlantique, Dakar | 2014 |
| • M.Sc., Statistical Engineering — ENSAE (National School of Statistics and Economic Analysis), Dakar | 2014 |

LANGUAGES

English (fluent) | French (fluent) | Wolof (native) | Spanish (intermediate)